Nicki Wahlers

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I love taking a cross-departmental problem and building the strategy and processes that actually make it work. As a Technical Program Manager, I've led initiatives that supported a 15x increase in organizational capacity by replacing ad-hoc, program-by-program work with clear metrics and repeatable operating systems. What energizes me most is the people side of it: getting engineers, executives, and frontline stakeholders on the same page and moving in the same direction.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Crime Stoppers of Houston

Technical Program Manager - All Programs | *Remote | November 2025 – August 2026*

- Led cross-functional programs across 8+ product lines, defining roadmaps and building scalable, repeatable operating systems that supported a 15x increase in organizational capacity and demand.
- Directed the strategy and launch of a student-centered platform, SafeSpace, coordinating across stakeholders to achieve 10x engagement and drive 26K users and 104K interactions in the first month.
- Led the coordination and delivery of a legislative-deadline-driven data analysis initiative, synthesizing inputs from multiple government data sources into clear findings that directly informed policy outcomes for Texas 2025 legislative session bills SJR 5, SB 9, SB 40, HB 75.
- Set strategy and organizational vision across portfolio initiatives, establishing KPIs, directing delivery timelines, and driving continuous process improvement to strengthen operational capabilities.

Product Manager | *Houston, TX | February 2025 – November 2025*

- Shipped 4 new data products, including a redesigned crime data dashboard and a university crime data dashboard, and delivered ongoing performance analysis to city council offices as a trusted external partner.
- Led a ground-up process improvement initiative, introducing Agile methodology and moving the team from ad-hoc, self-directed work to structured, predictable delivery cycles; a framework later adopted by other departments to improve quality and accountability.

Data Analyst | *Houston, TX | June 2024 – February 2025*

- Redesigned Research Center dashboards around real user needs including introducing an original interactive crime map, growing average monthly community reach from ~1,200 to ~80,000 (a 65x increase) and establishing the dashboards as the organization's primary public data resource.

Airship

Data Engineering Intern | *Portland, OR | January 2022 – June 2022*

- Contributed to a data pipeline supporting analytics for Airship's customer notification SDK, writing serialization code and tests to capture engagement data used by enterprise clients to measure performance.

Nike

Data Project Manager | *Beaverton, OR | March 2020 – May 2022*

- Catalogued and structured data on thousands of physical branding assets across the Nike WHQ campus, then partnered with app developers to translate the dataset into requirements for a tool used by Nike's Workplace Design and Development team to assess asset health and status.

Act-On Software

Software Engineering Intern | *Portland, OR | June 2021 – December 2021*

- Resolved a customer-reported data issue end-to-end, met with the customer to scope the problem, debugged the root cause in IntelliJ, fixed the malfunctioning input parser in Java with corresponding unit tests, and confirmed the resolution directly with the customer.

EDUCATION

- Portland State University - Portland, OR - Master of Science in Computer Science (MS), Software and Data Engineering
- Gonzaga University - Spokane, WA - Bachelor of Arts (BA), Mathematics and International Relations

SKILLS

Program & Process Management: Program Management, KPI Development, Performance Improvement, Process Development, Agile & Waterfall Methodologies, Project Planning, Strategic Roadmap Design, Cross-Functional Leadership, Stakeholder Engagement, Risk Mitigation, Resource Allocation, Change Management, Budget Management

Data & Analysis: Data Analysis & Reporting, Data Visualization, Trend Analysis, SQL, Data-Driven Decision Making, Business Modeling, Python

Tools and Platforms: Jira, Asana, Smartsheet, Tableau, Excel, Google Analytics, Microsoft Office Suite